

Ch 1: Power Sharing

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

Q1. What is power sharing? Why is it important in a democracy?

Q2. What is majoritarianism? Give one example from Sri Lanka. (PYQ)

Q3. What is the Sri Lanka Official Language Act of 1956? What was its impact?

Q4. What is civil war? What caused the civil war in Sri Lanka?

Q5. What is the ethnic composition of Belgium? Name the three linguistic groups.

Q6. What is the ethnic composition of Sri Lanka? Name the two major communities.

Q7. What is a 'Community Government' in Belgium? Who elects it?

Q8. What is horizontal distribution of power? Give one example. (PYQ 2016-17)

Q9. What is vertical distribution of power? Give one example.

Q10. What is checks and balances? How does it function in a democracy?

Q11. Identify the primary objective of power sharing arrangements in Belgium. (PYQ 2024)

Q12. Why is power sharing desirable? Give two reasons. (PYQ 2024)

Q13. What is the prudential reason for power sharing? (PYQ)

Q14. What is the moral reason for power sharing? (PYQ)

Q15. What is the Brussels arrangement in Belgium? Why was it significant?

Q16. Name any two ways in which Sri Lanka's Sinhala-dominated government discriminated against the Tamil minority.

Q17. What is federalism in the context of power sharing? Give one example.

Q18. What is the difference between the Belgian and Sri Lankan models of dealing with ethnic diversity?

Q19. Power is shared among different social groups in India. Give two examples of this.

Q20. What is a pressure group? How does it share in power in a democracy?

Q21. What are the two main reasons why power sharing is considered essential in modern democracies?

Q22. Name the four forms of power sharing arrangements in modern democracies.

Q23. What is a coalition government? How does it represent power sharing?

Q24. Assertion: Belgium shifted from a unitary to a federal form of government. Reason: Belgium wanted to accommodate the interests of different linguistic communities. Are both correct? Is R the correct explanation of A? (PYQ 2023)

Q25. What is the difference between power sharing among organs of government and power sharing among levels of government?

Q26. In India, how is power shared among social groups like SCs, STs, and OBCs? Give two examples.

Q27. What is undivided political power? Why is it considered dangerous in a democracy?

Q28. Name two countries that successfully resolved ethnic conflicts through power sharing.

Q29. What is the 'spirit of democracy'? How is it related to power sharing?

Q30. Why did the Tamils in Sri Lanka feel alienated from the government? Give two specific reasons.

Q31. What is the role of the judiciary in horizontal power sharing? Give one example from India.

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

Q1. Explain with examples the accommodative experience of Belgium for peace and harmony. (PYQ SQP 2020)

Q2. How is the idea of power sharing emerged? Explain the different forms of power sharing arrangements. (PYQ Delhi 2019)

Q3. Explain how Sri Lanka's majoritarian policies led to ethnic conflict and civil war. (PYQ — frequently asked)

Q4. Compare the approach of Belgium and Sri Lanka in dealing with ethnic diversity. Which approach was more successful and why? (PYQ — most repeated)

Q5. Explain the prudential and moral reasons for power sharing with examples. (PYQ)

Q6. Explain horizontal power sharing with three examples from Indian democracy.

Q7. Explain vertical power sharing with three examples from Indian democracy.

Q8. Explain how power is shared among social groups in India. Give three examples.

Q9. Explain how power is shared among political parties, pressure groups, and movements in a democracy. Give examples.

Q10. Explain the four forms of power sharing in modern democracies with one example each. (PYQ 2016-17)

Q11. "Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy." Explain this statement with three points.

Q12. How does power sharing help in reducing conflicts among different social groups? Explain with the example of Belgium. (PYQ)

Q13. Explain the ethnic composition of Belgium and the challenges it faced before the power sharing arrangement was worked out.

Q14. Describe the power sharing arrangement made in Belgium. How did it help maintain peace?

Q15. Describe the three key provisions of the power sharing arrangement in Belgium regarding languages and government.

Q16. How did the Sri Lankan government's majoritarian policies affect the Tamil minority? Explain with three specific measures.

Q17. Why is it important that power should not be concentrated in one organ of government? Explain with three points.

Q18. Explain the concept of checks and balances with three examples from democratic countries.

Q19. How does the sharing of power among different levels of government help a large and diverse country like India? Explain three points.

Q20. Explain how power sharing prevents the tyranny of the majority. Give two examples from countries discussed in the chapter.

Q21. Why did the Tamils in Sri Lanka demand a federal arrangement or separate state? Explain three reasons.

Q22. How did Belgium successfully prevent a civil war through power sharing when Sri Lanka failed? Compare three aspects.

Q23. Explain what would happen if all power was concentrated in one organ or one level of government. Give three likely consequences.

Q24. Explain how coalition governments represent power sharing among political parties. Is this healthy for democracy?

Q25. Explain the role of the legislature, executive, and judiciary in horizontal power sharing in India.

Q26. How has India adopted the model of power sharing similar to Belgium? Give three examples.

Q27. Explain why majoritarianism is considered a threat to democracy. Give three examples from Sri Lanka.

Q28. Explain three ways in which power sharing gives different sections of society a stake in the system of governance.

Q29. "Power sharing is not just about dividing power but also about ensuring participation." Justify with three points.

Q30. Explain how the community government system in Belgium helps prevent conflict between French and Dutch-speaking communities.

Q31. Describe three differences between the unitary and federal forms of power sharing.

Q32. How does reservation in India serve as a form of power sharing among social groups? Explain three aspects.

Q33. Explain three lessons that countries like India can learn from the Belgian and Sri Lankan experiences of power sharing.

Q34. Why do some people argue that power sharing leads to inefficiency and slow decision-making? Is this a valid concern? Give a balanced answer.

Q35. Explain three reasons why power sharing is considered a better alternative to the concentration of power in a democracy.

Q36. How does the concept of federalism relate to vertical power sharing? Explain with examples from India.

Q37. Explain how different political parties coming together to form a government represents a form of power sharing. Give two examples from India.

Q38. Explain three situations where the absence of power sharing has led to political instability or civil conflict in any country.

Q39. How do trade unions, business associations, and media function as forms of power sharing in a democracy? Explain with examples.

Q40. Describe the role of elections in ensuring power sharing among different political parties and groups in a democracy.

Q41. Explain what the ethnic composition of Sri Lanka is and how the dominant community used its majority to oppress minorities.

Q42. Explain three ways in which the Belgian model of power sharing can serve as an inspiration for multi-ethnic democracies around the world.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. Why is power sharing desirable? Explain with five reasons. (PYQ 2024)

Q2. Explain the accommodative experience of Belgium for peace and harmony. How did Belgium successfully manage ethnic diversity through power sharing? (PYQ SQP 2020)

Q3. Compare the Belgian and Sri Lankan models of dealing with ethnic diversity. Which approach was more successful? Analyse with five points. (PYQ — *most repeated*)

Q4. Explain the four forms of power sharing arrangements in modern democracies with examples from India and other countries. (PYQ 2016-17)

Q5. Explain how Sri Lanka's majoritarian policies led to ethnic conflict and eventually civil war. What lessons does this offer for other multi-ethnic nations?

Q6. "Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy." Justify this statement with five arguments covering participation, conflict reduction, stability, equality, and legitimacy.

Q7. Explain the prudential and moral reasons for power sharing. How do these reasons complement each other in a democracy? Give five examples.

Q8. Describe horizontal power sharing in detail. Explain the role of the legislature, executive, and judiciary in maintaining checks and balances. Give examples from India.

Q9. Describe vertical power sharing with reference to the federal structure of India. How does it help manage a diverse country? Give five specific examples.

Q10. Explain how power is shared in India among different social groups, political parties, pressure groups, and levels of government. Give five examples.

Q11. "The majoritarian model of Sri Lanka failed to maintain national unity whereas Belgium's accommodative model succeeded." Analyse this statement with five comparative points.

Q12. Explain the ethnic composition of Belgium and the power sharing arrangements worked out. How did each linguistic community benefit from these arrangements?

Q13. Explain the steps taken by the Sri Lankan government that discriminated against the Tamil minority. How did this lead to the demand for a separate state?

Q14. How does power sharing help prevent conflict between different social, religious, and linguistic groups in a diverse democracy? Explain with five examples.

Q15. "Concentration of power in one organ or one level of government is dangerous for democracy." Justify with five points and explain how power sharing prevents this danger.

Q16. Explain the relationship between federalism and power sharing. How does giving power to different levels of government help in managing diversity in a country like India?

Q17. Describe the role of elections, political parties, and coalition governments in ensuring power sharing in a democracy. Give five examples from India.

Q18. How has India adopted a system of power sharing that accommodates its linguistic, religious, and social diversity? Give five examples covering all four forms of power sharing.

Q19. "Power sharing does not just mean dividing power — it means making everyone a stakeholder in the system." Explain this statement with five arguments and examples.

Q20. Compare the power sharing models of Belgium and India. How has each country tried to accommodate ethnic, linguistic, and regional diversity?

Q21. Explain the evolution of the Belgian power sharing model step by step. Why was it necessary and how did it prevent the country from breaking apart?

Q22. Explain how the Sri Lankan Tamil community went from demanding equal rights to demanding a separate nation. Trace the five key steps that led to the civil war.

Q23. "Democracy is not just about majority rule — it is about power sharing with all." Justify this statement using examples from Belgium, Sri Lanka, and India.

Q24. Explain the significance of checks and balances in a democracy. How does the separation of powers among the legislature, executive, and judiciary prevent the abuse of power? Give five examples.

Q25. Why is power sharing considered essential for political stability and national unity? Explain with five examples from countries that have both succeeded and failed in managing diversity.

Q26. Explain how pressure groups, trade unions, media, and civil society organisations contribute to power sharing in a democracy. Why is their role important?